ALLO INNOWARE -- AI OPERATIONS MANAGER

Official Interview & Phone Call Cheat Sheet | Project Defense Guide

[*] CANDIDATE & REPOSITORY OVERVIEW

Candidate: Sanath S Gowda | Target Domain: E-Commerce & Marketplace Operations Automation
Tech Stack: Google Sheets, Apps Script, Webhook/Web App (doGet), Concurrency Locks, HTML Email Automation
GitHub: github.com/Sanathgowda-17/recurring-ops-automation | Sheet: docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1pt30OdGGjmo8_U7oqjAg3V4QRMNh3V6hm0Cz7OxmSdI

1. THE 60-SECOND PHONE CALL SCRIPT (MEMORIZE OR READ DIRECTLY)

Use this as soon as they ask: 'Can you tell us about what you have built?'

[MIC] WORD-FOR-WORD SPEAKING SCRIPT (NATURAL, CONFIDENT, PROFESSIONAL)

"At Allo Innoware, as a growing e-commerce brand, operations rely heavily on recurring cadences--from daily WhatsApp standup dispatches to weekly portal reconciliations and monthly closes. In most scaling teams, employees suffer from reporting friction and manual cycle drift--forgetting due dates or overwriting master sheets. Meanwhile, delays either get overlooked or dragged directly to the founders, causing micromanagement.

To solve this, I built a production automation prototype in Google Sheets and Google Apps Script:
1. Employees get an isolated Single-Point Workbench: they filter by name, paste their ticket ID or proof, and submit with zero friction.
2. Recurrence is 100% automated: the engine closes the cycle and auto-schedules the next cycle (skipping weekends for daily tasks).
3. Smart 2-Tier Escalation: managers get a same-day alert with an embedded 1-Click Ack button powered by an Apps Script Web App.
4. Leadership Shield: founders are only alerted if the manager breaches their 4-hour SLA.

I also built an automated test suite right into the sheet menu covering all 8 test scenarios with zero duplicate alerts."

2. THE 6-SHEET ARCHITECTURE (SEPARATION OF CONCERNS)

Why the system separates storage from employee interaction

Sheet Name	Role / Layer	Operational Purpose & Safeguards
Config	Control Center	Central parameters: Cutoff times (11 AM), Manager/Leadership emails, SLAs, Web App URL.
Task_Master	Catalog	Master definitions: Task IDs, cadences (Daily, 7d, 15d, 30d), assignees, proof requirements.
Active_Tasks	Live Queue	Heartbeat engine: Tracks cycle instances (TSK-001-C01), due dates, status, & alert timestamps.
Employee_Workbench	Single-Point UI	Filtered employee front-end. Enter proof in Col H, click Submit. Zero master database editing.
Manager_Dashboard	Executive KPI	Overhead summary: Pending, Alerted, Escalated counters, and team compliance percentages.
Audit_Log	Immutable Ledger	Permanent audit trail: actor, timestamp, event type, and before/after statuses.

3. TOP TECHNICAL & STRATEGIC INTERVIEW QUESTIONS (Q1 - Q5)

Exact answers to expected founder & hiring manager questions

Q1: Why did you build an Employee Workbench instead of letting team members edit Active_Tasks directly?

Directly editing master sheets is the primary cause of formula corruption and duplicate data in operations teams. When multiple employees work on a 20-column database simultaneously, they accidentally overwrite rows, filter other people's views, or miscalculate recurring dates. The Workbench serves as a clean front-end interface: employees see only what's assigned to them, type their proof in one designated green cell, and click Submit. The Apps Script backend handles database updates and cycle advances in the background with zero duplicate work.

*** KEY POINT TO SAY: Separation of concerns prevents human error and eliminates master sheet corruption.**

Q2: How did you solve the daily WhatsApp task (Test 3) since WhatsApp updates don't produce a Ticket ID?

This is a common real-world operational challenge. A simple Yes/No checkbox invites careless ticking, while full enterprise WhatsApp bots require heavy setup and monthly API fees. I implemented the 'Timestamp + Summary Snippet Protocol': the employee pastes the dispatch time and 1-line summary (e.g., 10:45 AM - 'Daily Ops: 18 dispatches on schedule, 0 delays') into the Workbench. It takes under 15 seconds, creates a searchable audit record, allows managers to spot-check against the WhatsApp group instantly, and automatically schedules the next business day.

*** KEY POINT TO SAY: Zero employee friction (<15s) with 100% auditability without expensive third-party tools.**

Q3: What prevents the automation from spamming duplicate emails or creating duplicate cycles? (Test 8)

I implemented two enterprise-grade safeguards: First, Concurrency Locking via Apps Script's LockService.getScriptLock().waitLock(30000). If an employee clicks Submit multiple times rapidly, the second thread detects the task is already completed and safely exits. Second, Atomic Timestamp Guards: before dispatching alerts or generating cycles, the engine checks Manager_Alert_Sent_At and Next_Cycle_Generated. Once stamped, subsequent automated cron scans immediately bypass that record. Test 8 verifies this by running the engine 3 times back-to-back--producing exactly 0 duplicate alerts and 0 duplicate cycles.

*** KEY POINT TO SAY: LockService concurrency locks + atomic timestamp flags guarantee 100% idempotency.**

Q4: How does the 1-Click Manager Acknowledgement work technically? (Test 5)

The automated alert email sent to the manager includes an HTML button: [Click Here to Acknowledge Task]. This button calls a deployed Google Apps Script Web App (ManagerWebApp.html) via its doGet() webhook endpoint with the task ID as a parameter. When clicked from email, the Web App validates the task, timestamps Manager_Acknowledged_At, updates status to 'Manager Acknowledged', records an audit event, and serves a clean confirmation page in the browser. This immediately pauses leadership escalation without requiring the manager to open Google Sheets on a desktop.

*** KEY POINT TO SAY: Zero friction for busy managers--can be acknowledged from a phone inbox in 2 seconds.**

Q5: How does your architecture specifically reduce founder dependency?

In unmanaged setups, whenever an operational task is delayed, either the founder spends time chasing employees, or issues go unnoticed until customer deliveries fail. My architecture creates an automated 2-tier SLA shield: the direct manager is alerted first and given a 4-hour resolution window. Founders/leadership are only alerted if the manager neglects their SLA. Routine operational delays stay at the operational manager tier, protecting executive leadership focus.

*** KEY POINT TO SAY: Automated 2-tier SLA shield stops executive micromanagement.**

4. DEEP-DIVE TECHNICAL QUESTIONS (Q6 - Q8)

Edge cases, business logic, and enterprise scaling

Q6: What happens if a daily task falls on a Friday or weekend?

The recurrence engine includes working-day intelligence in the calculateNextDueDate() function. When a daily task is completed on a Friday, the system checks the calendar day and advances by 3 days (skipping Saturday and Sunday), setting the next due date for Monday morning at 11:00 AM. This ensures realistic, business-accurate operational cadences.

*** KEY POINT TO SAY: Recurrence calculation automatically accounts for weekends and working days.**

Q7: How did you test all this? Can you prove it works?

I engineered an automated test runner directly into the Google Sheet under the custom menu: [!] Allo Innoware Ops > Run Test Scenarios. Evaluators can run individual tests from Test 1 to Test 8--such as 7-day cycle generation, single-point completion, same-day alert dispatch, 1-click acknowledgement, leadership escalation, and anti-duplication--or run the full test suite in one click. Every test verifies state changes and outputs an instant summary dialog.

*** KEY POINT TO SAY: Built-in automated test suite allows any evaluator to verify all 8 scenarios in 60 seconds.**

Q8: How does this system scale as Allo Innoware grows from 4 tasks to 100+ tasks?

The architecture is designed to scale across three operational phases: Phase 1 (Current Sheets Prototype): Uses batch array reading (getValues/setValues) to handle hundreds of tasks well within Apps Script execution limits. Phase 2 (Webhook Evolution): Integrate WhatsApp Cloud API / Twilio webhooks to intercept hashtags like #OPS_DONE directly into Apps Script. Phase 3 (Enterprise Modernization): The exact same relational schema and SLA state machine maps directly to PostgreSQL/Supabase and a lightweight React/Next.js dashboard as company volume scales.

*** KEY POINT TO SAY: Clear 3-phase roadmap from Google Workspace prototype to enterprise microservice.**

5. QUICK-REFERENCE: THE 8 TEST SCENARIOS MATRIX

What each test proves in the assignment

Test #	Name / Scenario	Key Behavior Verified	Sheet Proof
Test 1	7-Day Cycle Logic	Closes cycle 1, auto-generates cycle 2 (+7 days).	Active_Tasks: C01 -> C02
Test 2	Single-Point UI	Employee C submits Ticket ID from Workbench without master editing.	Employee_Workbench -> Active_Tasks
Test 3	Daily WhatsApp Proof	Captures timestamp + standup summary, schedules next business day.	Active_Tasks proof col & audit
Test 4	Same-Day Alert	Fires HTML email with 1-click ack button when cutoff passes.	Manager_Alert_Sent_At stamped
Test 5	Manager Ack	Web app records 1-click ack from inbox, pauses leadership escalation.	Manager_Acknowledged_At & status
Test 6	Leadership Escalation	Fires high-priority escalation to founders if manager breaches SLA.	Leadership_Escalation_Sent_At
Test 7	SLA Timing Matrix	Validates distinct SLA tiers: daily (4h SLA) vs periodic (24h SLA).	Config sheet parameter rules
Test 8	Anti-Duplication	Runs engine 3x consecutively: verifies 0 duplicate alerts/cycles.	LockService & idempotency logs

6. WINNING THE CALL: 4 PRACTICAL TIPS FOR SANATH

Deliver with confidence and executive poise

[TIP] EXECUTIVE DELIVERY GUIDELINES

* Offer a Live Demo Immediately: "I have the Google Sheet open right in front of me with the [!] Allo Innoware Ops menu. If you'd like, I can run any of the 8 test scenarios live or share my screen."
* Speak in Terms of Business Impact: Emphasize 'reducing founder micromanagement', 'eliminating manual cycle drift', and 'zero duplicate work'.
* Frame Sheets as the Pragmatic Starting Point: Explain that starting in Google Sheets enabled immediate zero-cost deployment while maintaining enterprise-grade safeguards like LockService and immutable audit logging.
* Stay Calm and Structured: Use the formula: Problem -> Architecture Solution -> Measurable Business Outcome.